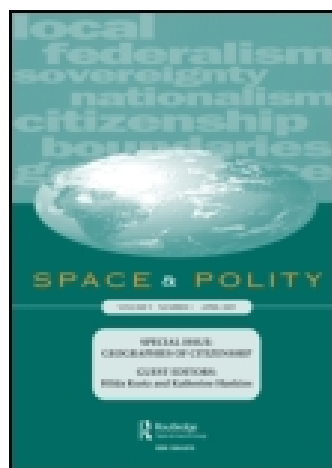


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Inter-local-government partnership for urban management in decentralizing Indonesia: from below or above? Kartamantul (Greater Yogyakarta) and Jabodetabek (Greater Jakarta) compared

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Inter-local-government partnership for urban management in decentralizing Indonesia: from below or above? Kartamantul (Greater Yogyakarta) and Jabodetabek (Greater Jakarta) compared

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Under the new decentralization policy, local governments in Indonesia tend to be inward-looking in orientation. Many local governments have exploited the local resources even more intensively, and they are not concerned with the socio-economic conditions of the larger region of which they are part. Within the context of metropolitan areas, there has been almost no effective cooperation among the bordering districts and municipalities to promote the metropolitan development. Against this backdrop, the study examines and compares the institutional partnership and governance in two Indonesia's metropolitan areas, namely Kartamantul (Greater Yogyakarta) and Jabodetabek (Greater Jakarta).

Keywords: local government; partnership; urban development; decentralization; Indonesia

At present, many developing and developed countries have shifted themselves from centralized to decentralized system due to the global trend of democratization and urbanization (Freire, 2007; Freire & Stern, 2001; see also Miller & Cox III, 2014). According to Grindle (2007), decentralization is an option for diminishing dependence of local-government on central government; for improving accountability; for institutionalizing change; and for encouraging economic development (see also Shah & Thompson, 2004, pp. 178–183). It involves a transfer of a significant degree of authorities and responsibilities for public expenditures and revenues from the central government to the local governments. With more local autonomy, it is expected that local government will take their own initiatives to promote local economic development.

Likewise, Indonesia's decentralization reform is expected to make the government become closer to the citizenry as a result of the empowerment of the local governments, local communities and local legislature councils. It is also hoped that the use of public funds will become more transparent, more effective and more efficient in promoting local development and improving the quality of public service provisions. However, the implementation of Indonesia's decentralization reform has been criticized for neglecting bottom-up accountability; design flaws in the fiscal equalization; and deficiencies in the operational capacity for local governance (Shah & Thompson, 2004, pp. 25–33). It has been considered successful in accomplishing some of its goals within a short period of time, but its longer term success is not assured as the reform has

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failed to recognize and give incentives for local governments to be accountable and responsive to the public (p. 34; see also Silver, 2003, p. 421).

The progress of decentralization policy overall, as implemented in Indonesia over nearly 10 years (1999–2009), has not led to uniform outcomes, in which some provinces, districts and municipalities have been able to develop impressively under the reform, but some are even worse off, depending in large part on the quality of leadership of the local elites, especially the heads of districts and municipalities. In fact, many heads of municipalities and districts have been able to bring economic development and better public service provisions to their regions. As Von Luebke (2009) argues:

[Under Indonesia's decentralization reform] the quality of government leadership ... emerges as a salient force driving the quality of policy outcomes ... [The] district heads with strong managerial skills and long-term career aspirations have successfully used their official powers to initiate broad-based reform and supervise bureaucratic performance. (p. 202)

Decentralization has granted the local governments much greater authority to implement development programmes, but the ability of the local governments to respond to the decentralization has varied considerably, depending on the various levels of local-government capacities. Moreover, in the absence of clear responsibilities for the local, provincial and central government authorities, the situation could undermine the potential economic externalities, which could be counterproductive to the objectives of the decentralization itself. Obviously, there is a need to establish a good local and regional governance institution to improve regional competitiveness in the era of decentralization reform in Indonesia.

Indonesia's new decentralization policy has greatly affected the behaviour of the local governments. In fact, many local governments, most notably, districts (*Kabupaten*) and municipalities (*Kota*), have exploited the local natural resources even more intensively. They have managed water, land and other physical assets to maximize their own income (*Pendapatan Asli Daerah*), and are not particularly concerned with the socio-economic and physical conditions of the region. In fact, many local governments have done excessive issuance of ordinances (*Peraturan Daerah*) intended to boost their revenues. Moreover, many local governments have plans to build new infrastructure, including seaports and airports, to compete with other regions and cities, and many of these plans disregard the problems of ineffectiveness and inefficiency associated with such huge investments. One of the major problems of new decentralization policy in Indonesia is that the country suffers from weak institutional capacity, which makes it difficult to carry out the implementation of the policy at both the national and local levels (see also Rimmer & Dick, 2009, especially chapter 9, pp. 251–275).

Many local authorities and local community leaders aim to contribute to the region according to their own socio-economic and political interests, and see no need to make partnership with neighbouring local governments. By partnership is meant cooperation between two or more neighbouring local governments, that is, *Kabupaten* and *Kota*, for the purposes of local and regional development. They occasionally engage with neighbouring governments if they see that a specific partnership is needed for local and regional development purposes. Overall, the local government in Indonesia now tends to be inward-looking in orientation.

Within the context of Indonesia's metropolitan regions, there have been almost no effective partnerships among the bordering districts and municipalities to promote urban and regional development in the areas. The operation and management of the inter-local-government partnership institutions are becoming a very important issue for a sustainable local and regional development in Indonesia, especially under the present decentralization policy (Firman, 2008, 2010; Hudalah, Zulfahmi, & Firman, 2013). Recently, the Central Government promulgated

Government Regulation (*Peraturan Pemerintah*) 50/2007 regarding procedure for implementation of inter-local-government partnership. Nonetheless, it appears that this regulation is too simplistic to regulate the complexity of inter-local-government cooperation in Indonesia.

Moreover, as Post (2004) maintains, local-government partnership, defined broadly as all levels of policy activities, including formal and informal agreements, requires coordination between local governments, and this could be key to the improvement of local governments' efficiency and to the reduction of social inequalities (pp. 67–69). Inter-local-government partnership has been a major issue of urban and regional development in large developing countries, such as China (Luo & Shen, 2009; see also Xu & Yeh, 2011).

According to Kitajima (1998, cf. Luo & Shen, 2009), partnership is referred as an organizational or institutional alliance between organizations of the public sector and those of the private sector (p. 53). Inter-local-government partnership requires innovative leaders who are willing to take advantage of the existing opportunities (Post, 2004, p. 79). Other key success factors in the partnership include free flow of information, trust and reciprocity (see Tjandradewi & Marcotullio, 2009). In the urban transformation in advanced societies since the 1970s, intercity cooperation and partnership have been a regional governance initiative to deal with problems resulting from strategies of urban entrepreneurialism and regional competition in the present globalizing world (Heeg et al., 2003). This kind of cooperation has been considered a new approach, when the traditional coordination approaches are no longer effective (Jessop, 1998, cf. Luo & Shen, 2009; see also Gu et al., 2011).

In the European context, according to Heeg et al. (2003, cf. Luo & Shen, 2009), there are three territorial types of intercity cooperation: (1) territorially disintegrated networks; (2) territorially integrated cooperation and (3) cooperation between two or more individual cities in the same large region. Moreover, there are three kinds of thematic cooperation in the European countries, which are, exchange of information, joint obligations and cooperation in market-regulated specialization field (p. 53). Nevertheless, as Luo and Shen argue, how the process of cooperation works and how the actors interact in the process have been largely neglected in research and in studies of intercity cooperation.

Against the above background, the aim of this study was to compare and examine the institutional governance of metropolitan areas in Indonesia, with case studies of *Kartamantul* (Greater Yogyakarta) and *Jabodetabek* (Greater Jakarta), both located on the island of Java. In addition to these two regions, there are some other metropolitan areas in Indonesia, namely *Gerbangkertasusila* (Greater Surabaya); *Bandung Raya* (Greater Bandung); *Kedungsepur* (Greater Semarang); *Mebidang* (Greater Medan) and *Maminasata* (Greater Makasar), but *Kartamantul* and *Jabodetabek* are considered to have more developed collaborative institutions compared with others. The *Kartamantul* area has a joint secretariat (*Sekretariat Bersama*) *Kartamantul*, which stands for Yogyakarta-Sleman-Bantul, the name of all local governments in the area, established to manage urban infrastructure development in the region, whereas *Jabodetabek* has a Cooperating Development Agency (*Badan Kerjasama Pembangunan – BKSP*) of *Jabodetabek*, whose task is to coordinate urban and regional development in the region. The study will focus on the comprehensive regional development for *Jabodetabek*, and will focus only on solid waste and wastewater management as a regional cooperation programme for the *Kartamantul* region.

The author has conducted analyses of these two case studies individually and separately (see Firman, 2008, 2010; Hudalah, Zulfahmi, & Firman, 2013), but the present study will go beyond by updating and bringing them together in a broader context and in a comprehensive manner. It will focus on evaluating and analysing the effectiveness of the partnership institution in *Kartamantul* and *Jabodetabek*, and the extent to which the other metropolitan areas in Indonesia can learn from the experience of these two.

These two metropolitan areas have distinct characteristics. Jakarta City, the core of the Jabodetabek, is the national capital, and also includes the largest concentration of urban population and economic activity in Indonesia. Meanwhile, Yogyakarta, the core of Kartamantul, is the capital of Yogyakarta Special Provincial Government.

The next section will examine the need for inter-local-government partnership institution for metropolitan development in the context of both Indonesia and developing countries in general. This will be followed by a critical discussion on the inter-local-government partnerships in Kartamantul (the Greater Yogyakarta) and Jabodetabek (the Greater Jakarta). The last section will conclude the discussion by comparing inter-local-government partnership in these two metropolitan regions.

The need for inter-local-government partnership institutions for urban and regional development

Decentralization in Indonesia might potentially bring several positive impacts for local and regional development. However, in reality, it has brought about spatial fragmentation, in which many local governments consider themselves to be ruling their own “kingdom of authority”, within which the provincial and even central government has little right to intervene with their authority. This attitude could in turn become a problem for development in the regions, since the local and regional development should be planned, implemented and monitored across jurisdictional boundaries, and should not be only focused on one district’s jurisdictional area.

The local governments, including those in Kartamantul and Jabodetabek, tend to maximize their own local income by exploiting available resources, and without considering the interests of their neighbouring districts or the province in which they are located. The central government also does not seem to be concerned with the emerging spatial fragmentation resulting from the practice of the present decentralization policy.

With a sense of euphoria, the local governments perceive decentralization and autonomy as more power given to them, but may not consider them also as more responsibilities for them to provide better quality of public services to the local citizens and to bring about socio-economic development for the region, at the first place. In fact, many heads of the districts and municipalities believe that they have a full discretion to determine whatever they think is best for them. As Matsui (n.d.) strongly argues, in the era of decentralization, the local and provincial governments in Indonesia have used decentralization to operate their own local centralized system, without any continued process of decentralization aimed at reaching the citizens in the regions. This obviously indicates a problem of governance institution, especially in the metropolitan areas, which may consist of several municipalities and districts. Governments are necessary, but not a sufficient condition, for governance (Oakerson, 2004, p. 20).

In general, governance refers to “the social processes by which binding decision for cities and regions are made and carried out” (Friedmann, 1999). There is a need to reconsider the actually existing territorial division of powers between central, provincial and local governments to ensure effective devolution of powers to the local units (pp. 4–8). As Feiock (2004) argues, at the local level, governance includes not only districts and municipalities, but also encompasses voluntary and non-profit organizations and intergovernmental linkages (p. 3).

The general objectives of governance are to promote vibrant, living and environmentally sustainable governing communities. According to Freire (2007), there are two biggest challenges in the local and regional governance: first, competitiveness: as to be a good place, regions should be competitive, and second, liveability, as the quality of living in a region is an important element of its competitiveness.

Local reform of governance institution is absolutely necessary for sustainable local and regional development. What is critically needed is a development of new forms of coordination, discussion and resolution of local and regional development policy issues at the macro and micro scales. The traditional local government cannot provide such forms of coordination and cross-scale mediation of interests (Stubbs & Clarke, 1996, p. 93). A good local and regional governance institution is critically needed to improve regional competitiveness, whereas the biggest challenge is how to establish an appropriate governance institution form which can change the culture and attitude of governance and optimize the potential of urban and regional development.

A particular country should choose the regional governance types depending on the historical, socio-economic, cultural and political characteristic of the country, in which no “one size fits all” (see also Bird & Slack, 2007). Asian countries, including Indonesia, ought to develop their own national, regional and local development policies, strategies, and institutions which are indigenously formulated, including the institutional set up (McGee, 2005, p. 51). Metropolitan governance can basically range from the informal coordination of service delivery to the establishment of metropolitan governments (Feiock, 2004).

Metropolitan areas should be developed as a functional and inseparable area through an integrated spatial development plan to ensure sustainable development in the regions, implemented through an effective inter-local-government and central government partnership, regardless the local-government jurisdictional area within the cities and regions. According to Feiock (2004), metropolitan cooperation can take several forms, including inter local agreement between two or more government units; coalitions of local governments seeking central government grants; public–private regional partnerships; metropolitan authorities and consolidated metropolitan governments (p. 243).

Similarly, as Laquian (2005a, 2005b) argues, there are several models of sub-national governance institutions that have been applied in both developed and developing countries: (1) one-tier autonomous local governance which can be divided into two forms, either small fragmented municipalities and districts in the metropolitan area or a large consolidated municipalities and districts for the whole metropolitan area; (2) multi-tier confederated regional governance; (3) mixed or voluntary system of metropolitan governance and (4) special or single-purpose districts. Nonetheless, any metropolitan governance model that is adopted must take into consideration the socio-economic, political and geographical conditions of the concerned regions. In particular, there are several conditions which are likely to affect inter-local-government cooperation, as Post (2004) argues:

Three conditions negatively influence intergovernmental cooperation: increasing numbers of local governments seeking to cooperate, (2) increasing heterogeneity of the populations served by the local governments, and (3) increasing regulation of local-government behavior by state laws. [In contrast], five conditions positively the likelihood of local-government cooperation: (1) increasing geographic density of local governments, (2) increasing homogeneity of populations served by local governments, (3) common policy objectives among the local governments seeking to cooperate [...], (4) presence of strong leaders and entrepreneurs, and (5) federal incentives for local-government cooperation. (p. 82)

As Luo and Shen (2009) maintain, basically, there are three stages of intercity cooperation, including the first stage, which is an information exchange, which emphasizes flexible negotiation and mutual learning between cities; the second stage is when member cities may begin to cooperate in some real fields; the third stage is when member cities begin to establish a common market (regional integration) in order to enhance competitiveness (p. 59). Nevertheless, in the case of Yangtze river delta region in China, Luo and Shen (2009) found that there are three factors which affect the results of intercity-government cooperation; (1) the cooperation is

affected by how it is mobilized, in which hierarchical partnership, spontaneous partnership or hybrid partnership may have different outcomes; (2) the effectiveness of the cooperation is affected by the scope of cooperation, that is, the nature and content of the partnership agreed upon as the common project and (3) the success of cooperation depends on member city selection and the role of actors during partnership formation (p. 61).

In summary, decentralization could imply the need for more cooperation and partnership with neighbouring districts and municipalities. Most likely, the local governments will not be able to solve their local development problems by themselves without such cooperation. The parochial attitude of many local governments has caused a number of problems in service delivery, which requires cross-border cooperation. In particular, solid waste management and water supply delivery, and transport management have suffered considerably in many metropolitan areas in Indonesia as well as in most large cities of developing countries. In the context of Indonesia's regional autonomy and decentralization, coordination among the local government within a region seems to be far more complicated and difficult than was expected. In fact, the decentralization policy seems to create obstacle for inter-local-government partnership, but it does not necessarily mean that decentralization policy is bad. What is needed first of all is a good collective leadership linking local-government leaders, including a vision about how to develop the region through the cooperation of all stakeholders, and an understanding of the critical importance of improving institutions of local and regional development.

Inter-local-government partnership in Kartamantul (the Greater Yogyakarta) for urban infrastructure development and management

The Metropolitan Kartamantul consists of one municipality, that is, the City (*Kota*) of Yogyakarta, and two districts (*Kabupaten*), namely Bantul and Sleman, all of which belong to the Special Province of Yogyakarta (DIY Yogyakarta). The total area of urban agglomeration in this metropolitan area is 234 square kilometre (sq km), including 33 sq km in the City of Yogyakarta; 108 sq km and 93 sq km in the Districts of Sleman and Bantul, respectively, while the population of the area was nearly 2 million in 2008, of which two-fifth was urban population. The City of Yogyakarta is the core of the Kartamantul region, which has spilled over to the surrounding areas in Sleman and Bantul. In fact, the District of Sleman has recently become increasingly urban in character.

Economic activities in the area are predominantly the agricultural sector, but other economic activities are growing rapidly, including tourism, higher education, the art and handicraft industry, and trade, especially in the City of Yogyakarta. In the District of Sleman, the domestic investment has reached Rp 332 billion (US\$30.2 million), whereas the direct foreign investment has reached US\$ 13.4 billion by 2008. In addition, more than 4000 small and medium enterprises have been able to contribute as much as Rp 90.5 trillion to the Gross Domestic Products (GDPs) of the Districts, and created more than 62 thousand job opportunities (Jakarta post, 2008).

On the initiative of all the local governments in the Kartamantul area, a joint secretariat (*Sekretariat Bersama*) was established in 2001 to manage the infrastructure development in the area. All heads of the local governments signed an agreement, with the Governor of the Special Province (*Daerah Istimewa*) of Yogyakarta putting his support signature. However, the government of Province of Yogyakarta is not actively involved in the implementation of infrastructure in practice in the field, but only as a facilitator to ensure that the joint secretariat work effectively, to become a mediator should there be a dispute among the local governments involved in this cooperation.

The objective of establishing the joint secretariat was to create balanced and harmonious development and management of the physical infrastructure in the area, by enhancing the

coordination in planning and implementation and monitoring and evaluating infrastructure development. All of the local governments involved were aware that urban infrastructure development would only reach optimum performance only if it were managed as a system, regardless of the existing administrative boundaries (Sutrisno, 2004).

In the past, during the new order era, the management of infrastructure in the Kartamantul was coordinated and managed by the Special Province Government of Yogyakarta. Nevertheless, these three local governments were accustomed to working together under the Special Provincial Government of Yogyakarta. They had experience working together in the 1980s and 1990s on the Integrated Urban Infrastructure Development Program, technically supported by the Ministry of Public Works, and financed by a loan from the Asian Development Bank.

Another factor that encouraged all the local governments to establish the joint secretariat was the interdependence among them. The fact is that the District of Sleman, which is located in the upper region of central Yogyakarta watershed area, needs to maintain its function as the water recharge area, but this district also needs access to the lower region for its own waste disposal. Likewise, the City of Yogyakarta, the core of Kartamantul, is the prime mover of economic development in the region, but has very limited space for waste disposal. Meanwhile, the District of Bantul, located in the lower part of the metropolitan area, has potential for various waste disposal development projects, but obviously needs to maintain a healthy environment despite the interest of people involved in socio-economic activities in the upper region, that is, Yogyakarta and Sleman (Sutrisno, 2004). At present, the joint secretariat activities are focused on six areas of cooperation for urban infrastructure; water supply, wastewater, solid waste management, public transportation, roads and drainage systems.

The main targets of the Kartamantul solid waste management programme are to formulate the cost-sharing for operation and maintenance of Piyungan dump site in the Bantul District; to determine the most appropriate technology for solid waste management; and to formulate the solid waste retribution for these three districts in an integrated manner. The present capacity of the Piyungan dumpsite area is 2.7 million cubic metre with an assumption of a recycling rate of 20% per year. This is to be increased up to 50% per year, whereas the lifetime of this site can add up to 13 years, starting from the year 2000. This programme was made into an official contract among the Municipality of Yogyakarta and the Districts of Sleman and Bantul in 2001. The Municipality of Yogyakarta has contributed nearly 80% to the total charge for solid waste management in Kartamantul (Table 1), whereas the Provincial Government of Yogyakarta contributed approximately 90% towards the financing of wastewater management in the region (Table 2). The Piyungan area has been selected because the area is wide enough and because of the low

Table 1. Contribution of local governments for solid waste management in Kartamantul, 2001–2008 (in million rupiah).

Year	Yogyakarta	Sleman	Bantul	Total ^a
2001	599.3	100.9	42.6	742.9
2002	738.7	124.4	52.5	915.7
2003	895.3	150.8	74.9	1121.0
2004	1035.6	174.4	86.6	1296.6
2005	1281.4	215.8	107.2	1604.3
2006	1571.6	264.7	131.4	1967.7
2007	1789.1	310.2	149.6	2240.1
2008	1853.1	355.3	153.6	2362.0

Source: Suryokusumo (2009).

^aDiscrepancy due to rounding.

Table 2. Contribution of local and provincial governments for wastewater management in Kartamantul, 2005–2008 (in million rupiah).

Local gov.	2005	2006	2007	2008
Yogyakarta	125.0	125.0	125.0	145.0
Sleman	10.0	10.0	10.0	20.0
Bantul	10.0	10.0	10.0	20.0
The provincial gov. of Yogyakarta	650.0	777.0	849.9	1000.0
Total	785.0	922.0	994.9	1185.0

Source: Suryokusumo (2009).

population density in the Kartamantul region, to ensure minimum negative environmental impacts to the human settlements (Sutrisno, 2004).

In the near future, it is expected that management of Piyungan dumpsite operation will be implemented by a private company, whereas the joint secretariat will become the project owner, so that there will be a kind of public–private partnership scheme for solid waste management in the area. In fact, Shimizu Corporation, a Japanese company is seriously interested in becoming an investor for utilizing methane gas (CH₄) in this dumpsite. In fact, an MOU (Memorandum of Understanding) for a cooperation was signed between the joint secretariat and the company in April 2008, reflected in a project titled “Piyungan Landfill Site Methane Gas Capture and Utilization”, which will involve a change in the technology of solid waste management from a conventional dumpsite to several modern technology with more environmental friendly features, involving nine steps to be taken, including (1) closure of landfill site (soil cover and surface drainage); (2) collection of LPG (landfill gas); (3) flare equipment (destruction of methane); (4) purification of gases; (5) gas engine generation (utilization of methane); (6) grid connection to electric power line; (7) office housing and monitoring facilities; (8) leachate water treatment and (9) allowing waste takers’ group to work without any conflict in the area (Piyungan Landfill Site Methane Gas Capture and Utilization Project: Idea Note, 2008). In planning and operation, this company will be technically assisted by the Agency for the Assessment and Application of Technology (BPPT).

The construction was started in 2008, whereas the project was expected to begin in 2010, with lifetime for about 10 years, until 2020. This project will utilize about 4200 tonnes of methane gas in 2012 which will increase up to 512,310 tonnes in 2019–2021, which could produce electricity power of 1–2 megawatt. Moreover, this project is also expected to reduce the emission of greenhouse gases in Piyungan area up to 51,231 tCO₂ equivalent per year (Japan Quality Assurance Organization, 2009). In fact, Shimizu Corporation is expecting to become a Kyoto Protocol Certificate recipient from the United Nations very soon.

The river and surface waters in Kartamantul area are heavily polluted, mostly due to household waste problems and waste of industries located in the region. There is a need to mitigate the pollution by installing wastewater processing installation (WWPI). The management of Kartamantul WWPI has aimed to prepare the budget of WWPI provision and share the budget among the local governments involved, evaluating and monitoring the performance of WWPI, with respect to the environmental, technical, institutional, financial and social conditions. The other tasks include conducting studies of the efficiency of WWPI operation, utilizing mud wastewater, and determining the willingness to the consumers; determining the structure and retribution tariff; and conducting integrated environmental management programmes (Sutrisno, 2004). By developing the WWPI, it is expected that the waterbody could be protected from the pollution of domestic wastewater; the quality of the environment could be improved; and wastewater

products could be utilized as organic fertilizer. The WWPI is located in Sewon area in the District of Bantul, with a strength of 110,000 household consumers. At present, only about 10% of the WWPI's capacity is being utilized.

The Kartamantul Joint Secretariat consists of three levels of management. On the top level of decision-making, there are the mayor (*Walikota*) of Yogyakarta City, and the heads (*Bupati*) of Sleman and Bantul Districts. The second level involves senior officers, including the secretary of the local governments and the head of local planning agencies, head of the treasury departments and some heads of technical departments in the local governments, whereas the lowest layer consists of lower rank officers who are responsible for the technical implementation (Sutrisno, 2004).

The working process is started at the lowest level, in which every issue of infrastructure development in Kartamantul is thoroughly discussed and technically examined. The discussion includes attention to the interests of every local-government member, and focus agendas which could be in conflict with one another. If consensus has been reached and accepted by this working group, the decisions are then brought to the second level of management for further discussions and the signing of an agreement document. The final step is the development of official consensus among the three local governments regarding the issue, signed by all the heads of local governments on the official jointly produced agreement document. Once the agreement document is signed, each local government should be in charge of implementing it themselves. All of the local governments involved are satisfied with the joint secretariat's efforts towards integrating across local-government boundary urban infrastructure management.

In addition to management of solid waste and wastewater management, the local governments of Yogyakarta, Bantul and Sleman have reached an agreement on the management of water supply, the transport system and road development management, but so far, not much progress has been reached in practice in these areas.

One of the important factors in the success of the Kartamantul joint secretariat is the shared vision and leaderships of all heads of the local governments in the area. They share a view of the role of urban infrastructure in urban and regional development in the area. The other factor is the negotiation process among the local governments involved, in which they may have different and often conflicting interests, but they share the common vision that urban infrastructure development should be implemented in a synergistic way in order to provide a better quality public service. The organization of the Kartamantul joint secretariat is basically a collective horizontal decision-making process. There are some classical problems that of course exist in the operation of Kartamantul Secretariat, including insufficient financial resources, human resources and capacity.

The operation of the Secretariat has been assisted by generous support from the Germany Technical Cooperation (GTZ) through GTZ Urban Quality since 2003, which includes strengthening its functions and tasks; focusing on implementation of cooperation; identifying lessons learnt in urban management and planning; supporting the process of effective cooperation; facilitating legal form and organization; enhancing the quality of decision-making process; and improving stakeholder involvement in various aspects (Sutrisno, 2004, p. 7).

The Kartamantul joint secretariat was found very effective in coordinating the management of physical infrastructure development in the region at a certain level of performance. However, there are many other interregional problems that still need to be addressed, most notably, Kartamantul's regional development, which is much broader than merely the infrastructure. All the local governments have full understanding of this matter, and they have, therefore, carried out an exploratory study to identify more effective organizational structures to enhance the joint secretariat in its efforts to deal with the growing challenges of development in the region in the future. There are three options that have been formulated for the future of the joint secretariat of

Kartamantul, including (1) a forum for coordination, concentrating on supporting process-oriented decision-making; (2) an executing agency, charged with implementation, monitoring and evaluation and (3) a shareholder association (Sutrisno, 2004, p. 8).

In short, Kartamantul Secretariat is a bottom-up initiative of three local governments in Jogjakarta Metropolitan Area aimed at managing and coordinating the infrastructure development in the region. Such development should be carried out in an integrated manner across the local governments' boundaries in the region, not in an individual manner by each local government. At present, the programme is focused on the infrastructure development, but the challenges of development of this region are far greater than that. One challenge is the sustainability of this inter-local-government partnership, since it greatly depends upon the leadership of the heads of local governments, not on the system of institutional collaboration among the local governments. If the heads of the local governments are replaced because they have completed their terms of service, for instance, there is no guarantee that this cooperation could continue at the same level of quality. Another problem is that as the challenges of development grow, the capacity of the joint secretariat (*Sekertariat Bersama*) needs to be improved greatly.

The multi-local Government institution for Jabodetabek (Greater Jakarta)

Jabodetabek (Greater Jakarta) is the largest of urban concentrations in Indonesia, with the total population of nearly 20 million by 2008, while the population of Jakarta reached about 9 million. The total area of Jabodetabek is approximately 7700 sq km, whereas the City of Jakarta is about 660 sq km.

Many economic activities are located in the region, including manufacturing industry, finance, trade, property and service sectors. The cumulative approved foreign investment reached nearly US\$17 billion during 2000–2005, which accounted for almost 25% of total approved investment in Indonesia at the time, excluding investment in oil and gas sector (see Firman, Kombaitan, & Pradono, 2007). By mid-2000s alone, the city of Jakarta produced one-sixth of Indonesian GDP, twice as much as that of mid-1970s (Hill, 2008, p. 48). The fact is that Jabodetabek is growing into one of the largest mega urban regions in Southeast Asia.

Jabodetabek has been affected by some changes in jurisdictions. First, in the very early 2000, the Province of West Java was divided into two provinces, that is, the Provinces of West Java and Banten. The District of Tangerang and the Municipality of Tangerang, which used to be under the Province of West Java, came under the jurisdiction of the Province of Banten. Second, in the early 2000s, the City of Depok, which used to be a sub-district (*Kecamatan*) within the District (*Kabupaten*) of Bogor, became a municipality itself, and no longer fell under the jurisdiction of the District of Bogor. Third, during the President Suharto's era in the early 1990s, the Municipalities of Bekasi and Tangerang were established, independent of their mother districts, that is, the Districts of Bekasi and Tangerang, after being given the status of *Kota Administratif*, literally meaning Administrative Cities, for about three years. Recently, the central government has also agreed to the Parliament's proposal to establish the independent Municipality of Tangerang Selatan (South Tangerang) separated from the City of Tangerang.

At present, the management of Jabodetabek's development is coordinated by *BKSP Jabotabek* (Cooperating Agency for Jakarta Metropolitan Development) which was established jointly by the Provincial Government of West Java and the Special Capital Government of Jakarta in 1975. The membership of this body consists of all heads of provincial, district and municipal governments within the region, which include the Provincial Government of West Java, Banten and Jakarta; the City Government (*Pemerintah Kota*) of Bogor, Tangerang, Bekasi and Depok; and the District Government (*Pemerintah Kabupaten*) of Bogor, Tangerang, Bekasi dan Cianjur. The BKSP is headed jointly by the Governors of Jakarta, the Provinces of West Java and

Banten, while the daily operation is managed by an executive secretary appointed by the Minister of Home Affairs on the recommendation of all Provincial Governments, working in five-year rotation (see also Dharmapatni & Firman, 1995).

The establishment of the BKSP was then reinforced by the Decree of the Minister of Internal Affairs no. 29 in 1980, and then by the Decree of the Minister of National Planning and Head of National Planning Agency no. 125 in 1984. Later, the organizational structure of BKSP was reorganized by the Decree of the Minister of Internal Affairs no. 6 in the year 2000, which explicitly stated the Governors of West Java, Jakarta and Banten as co-chair, and all heads of Districts (*Bupati*) and Municipalities (*Kota*) in the region as members of this agency. Moreover, Law 29/2007 regarding the Provincial Government of Jakarta as the Capital of the Unitary State of Republic of Indonesia clearly states the importance of cooperation between the Provincial Government of Jakarta and all provincial and local governments bordering with the City of Jakarta. Inter-local-government cooperation in the Jabodetabek area should be developed to strengthen the scale of economic production and service activities in the region, on the basis of agreement and common interests among the concerned local and provincial governments.

The BKSP does not possess the authority in implementation of development in the Jabodetabek area, as each provincial and local government in the area holds its own authority. This has made the BKSP powerless and ineffective in coordinating and monitoring the development programme in the region. Moreover, this institution does not have manpower or financial resources of its own, as it is substantially dependent on the financial supports from the Provincial Government of Jakarta, West Java and Banten (Firman, 2008, see also Sekretariat BKSP, 2009). Nevertheless, the existence of the BKSP has been politically accepted by all provincial and local governments and provincial and local legislative councils (*Dewan Perwakilan Rakyat Daerah*) in the region.

This body is essentially a powerless coordinating forum. It functions only to facilitate and coordinate meeting of local-government members of this body to discuss several development issues in the area, including spatial and infrastructure development, but does not have the authority for implementing it. Therefore, not much development actions have been done by them. However, they have been able to facilitate some agreement among the local-government members, including agreement on cooperation in population administration to avoid multiple ID cards in Jabodetabek, and coordinate point of borders between the Provincial Government of West Java and Jakarta. The present Governor of Jakarta Provincial Government, Mr Fauzi Bowo, strongly argues that there is a need to revitalize BKSP Jabodetabek and there should be a stronger regulatory framework for them to operate more effectively.

At present, Jabodetabek area faces a problem of regional development resulting from the spatial fragmentation in the area (Firman, 2003). Unless there is a metropolitan governance institution established to integrate development in the region, with their own authority and autonomy, the Jabodetabek development will be difficult to manage in a comprehensive manner. In turn, this could potentially jeopardize the sustainable development of the region in the near future. Actually, the central government has drafted a spatial plan (*Rencana Tata Ruang*) for Jabodetabek Area, legalized in the Presidential Decree no. 54 in the year 2008, but in the absence of strong metropolitan governance institution, it is unlikely that the plan can be successfully implemented.

Recently, there was a dispute between the Jakarta City Government with the provincial government of West Java and Banten. The former Jakarta governor, Mr Sutiyoso, introduced a concept of "Megapolitan" in the mid-2000s arguing the need for an integration of development management among the many stakeholders in the Jabodetabek area. He was accused by many local leaders and politicians in Banten and West Java of having interests in expanding Jakarta's administrative region to encroach on some districts (*Kabupaten*) in West Java and Banten. He was also even accused of hoping to gain the proposed position of "Minister of Jabodetabek" himself. Nevertheless, some West Java's and Banten's districts in Jabodetabek supported Sutiyoso's idea

because they felt neglected by the Provinces of Banten and West Java. Although the idea was a bit controversial, it is worth considering, given that it may improve the development management for the Jabodetabek area.

To cite another governance problem in the Jabodetabek, very recently, there was a dispute between the City Government of Jakarta and the Municipality of Bekasi over the dump site for the estimated 4500 tonnes of garbage sent daily from Jakarta to the dump site of Bantar Gebang in Bekasi, out of total 6500 tonnes of garbage produced in Jakarta City per day. The Municipality of Bekasi had expressed their interest in not extending the contract with the City Government of Jakarta to use the Bantar Gebang area, which is scheduled to end in 2009, after almost 20 years of operation which had resulted in more than 10 million tonnes of garbage mounted in the site. Yet, the Jakarta City government has never complied with the contract, which states that the city government of Jakarta should develop sustainable solid waste management in the area, and should provide electricity generators that use garbage as input materials for the communities in the area. In reply, the City Government of Jakarta argues that they have increased the “tipping fee”, that is, a kind of garbage compensation paid by them to the Municipality of Bekasi from Rp 60,000 to Rp 103,000 per tonne. If the Bekasi municipality does not extend the contract, the loss of the site dumping will become a big problem for the city government and people of Jakarta, because the garbage will mount in Jakarta city, unless the city government can find an alternative dump site, an unlikely prospect at present (see Firman, 2008). Nevertheless, termination of the contract could also become a problem to the Municipality of Bekasi itself, as they may lose a significant revenues source (*Pendapatan Asli Daerah – PAD*), that is, about Rp 21 billion out of total PAD of Rp 230 billion rupiah per year in mid-2000s.

Eventually, the Jakarta City government and the Municipality of Bekasi were able to reach an agreement to extend the contract, after a tough and long process of negotiation at the end of 2008. At present, the operation of this site is managed by a private company (PT Godang Tua Jaya) until 2023, using Galfad technology (gasification, landfill and anaerobic digestion) and applying 3R Process (Reduce, Reuse and Recycle) with investment of Rp 700 billion. In addition, another contractor, PT Navigat Organic Energy Indonesia is planning to operate an electricity generator plant (Pembangkit Listrik Tenaga Sampah) (see Yudistira, 2009), utilizing raw material of methane gas produced by the mounted garbage in the area, which can potentially process 45,000 tonnes of garbage daily to produce 26 megawatt electricity power, to be sold to the state-owned electricity company (Perusahaan Listrik Negara). In addition, this company will receive a tipping fee from the Provincial Government of Jakarta, as much as Rp 103,000 per tonne of processed garbage (Patnistik, 2008).

The central government should play an important role and therefore should be greatly involved in the Jabodetabek area development, because Jakarta City, the core of the Jabodetabek, is the national capital. The capital city’s urban development needs support and significant contributions from the central government, as the physical infrastructure development in this region will require enormous financial resources, beyond the technical and financial capacities of all local and provincial governments in the Jabodetabek region. Given this situation, the most appropriate governance model for Jabodetabek is a mixed model, in which central, provincial and local governments play a specific role in the governance of the region (see also Laquian, 2005a, 2005b). Nevertheless, an establishment of the BKSP as a mixed model for governance institution for the Jabodetabek metropolitan region should be given a proper legal basis (*undang-undang*) to make this institution work effectively (see Firman, 2008).

This proposed governance body needs to be given the authority to plan and develop a major structure of physical infrastructure project for the whole area, notably in the arenas of transportation system, spatial development plans, solid waste management and watershed management. Under the proposed institution, the provincial and local governments will be expected to give

up their authority over the above functions, but still retain their authority on local-government administration. This would imply that BKSP, as a metropolitan authority, should be coordinated by a central government officer, and be in charge only of planning, implementation and monitoring of major infrastructure development for Jabodetabek (see Firman, 2008). With regard to other local-government public-service functions, this institution should only implement coordination, as the real authority shall continue to be with the local governments.

Kartamantul and Jabodetabek compared: from below or above?

Indonesia embarked on far-reaching decentralization in 2001. As a consequence, local governments now have a great deal of independence, and their leaders are now popularly elected. Previously, government was largely centralized, even to the extent that local leaders were effectively appointed by the central government. In those circumstances, coordination and partnership between different governments and different levels of government were not much of a problem. Now, under the decentralization reform, the situation has greatly changed, as the local governments have more authority and discretions to decide development programmes and practise themselves, without much intervention from the central and provincial governments. Given this context, inter-local-government partnership becomes a necessary part of Indonesia's decentralization policy, because the local governments will not be able to promote socio-economic development in the region without such a partnership.

Indonesia's new decentralization policy could potentially bring about opportunities for local governments to manage local and regional development according to their own aspirations and potential, but in reality, it has resulted in a spatial fragmentation. Local governments have come to consider themselves "Kingdom of their own authorities" and provincial and central governments have only minimal right to intervene with their policies and practices of development. Meanwhile, many of the local governments and local politicians have little interest in building partnerships with the bordering districts or municipalities. Now, in the era of decentralization, Indonesia needs some kind of inter-local-government partnership models that can be used as a reference by any inter-local-government cooperation, most notably Kabupaten and Kota.

This study shows different models of metropolitan governance practised in Indonesia. It has critically discussed the cooperation of inter local and inter provincial governments in Kartamantul (the Greater Yogyakarta) and Jabodetabek (the Greater Yogyakarta). In comparison, Kartamantul is much smaller than Jabodetabek in terms of local and provincial governments involved, size of the area, size of population and the scale of economic activities.

The Kartamantul joint secretariat was established based on local (bottom-up) initiatives during the reform era, whereas the BKSP Jabodetabek was set up with a top-down approach, initiated by the central government during the New Order of President Suharto era (Table 3). Nevertheless, referring to Luo and Shen (2009) stage of intercity cooperation, both Kartamantul and Jabodetabek belong to the second stage of cooperation, that is, member cities begin to cooperate in some concrete fields, not yet reaching regional integration (common market) (p. 59).

The City of Yogyakarta, the core of Kartamantul, has a long history as the seat of Javanese Sultan Palace. The economic activities in the city include tourism, handicrafts and higher education. Meanwhile, Jakarta City as the core of Jabodetabek, is the national capital and holds the largest concentration of urban population and the highest rates of urban economic activity in Indonesia. Nevertheless, most important of all, these two inter-local-government metropolitan institutions have been acceptable to all the local and provincial governments involved. Thus, they can be used as a basis for development of both institutions in the near future.

The Kartamantul joint secretariat operation has been focused on the management of urban infrastructure development in the area, whereas the BKSP Jabotabek has a much broader scope,

Table 3. The joint secretariat of Kartamantul and the cooperating development agency (BKSP) of Jabodetabek compared.

	The joint secretariat of Kartamantul	The cooperating development agency for Jabodetabek (BKSP Jabodetabek)
Provincial and local governments involved	The Province of Yogyakarta, The Municipality of Yogyakarta and the Districts of Sleman and Bantul	The Provincial Governments of Jakarta, West Java and Banten; The Municipalities and the Districts of Bogor, Tangerang, Bekasi, and Depok
Core and its functions	Yogyakarta City; A middle-sized city, centre of tourism and higher education activities	Jakarta City; The national capital and the largest concentration of urban population and economic activities
Coverage of cooperation	Limited to urban infrastructure and development, especially wastewater and solid waste management	Broader metropolitan development, including, but not limited to, spatial and infrastructure development
Initiative	All the local governments (2000); bottom-up (local) initiative, with a significant role of Sultan as the Governor and Leader of Special Province of Yogyakarta	Central Government and the Provincial Governments of West Java and Jakarta (1975); top-down initiative, but politically acceptable to the stakeholders
Problems	Limitation of the function; lack of financial resources and manpower	Lack of power and authority; does not function as a metropolitan authority
Challenges	Development of institution to be able to deal with broader local and regional development issues, including spatial planning and transport system development	Restructuring the authority of the institution, by involving central, provincial and local governments in the context of Indonesia's Decentralization Reform
Future development	Three options: coordinating agency; implementing agency; or shareholder association	Transformation the institution to become a mixed model of a metropolitan governance

that is, all aspects of regional development in the region. Apparently, the Secretariat has a limited capacity to deal with the comprehensive regional development in the region. Additional classical problems faced by Kartamantul joint secretariat include lack of financial resources and qualified human resources to fully operate the programmes of infrastructure development in the region. Nevertheless, the joint secretariat has made a great contribution to the practice of integrated infrastructure development, despite the constraints in the managerial and technical capacity. It has also provided a very good lesson on how to develop a collaborative relationship between local governments in a secondary (middle sized) metropolitan area in Indonesia. Nevertheless, the Kartamantul joint secretariat faces the problem of sustainability of this cooperation in the future, because, at present, it works due to persons involved in it, not based on a robust system.

There are three options for the future of Kartamantul joint secretariat, including as coordinating agency; implementing agency or shareholder association. In a short run, 5–10 years to come, it seems that coordinating and perhaps implementing agency are the most plausible options, but in the long run, 10–20 years to come, the secretariat could become a shareholder association, responsible for infrastructure which need cross-border collaboration and cross-scale mediation of interest (see also Stubbs & Clarke, 1996). It is expected that the scope of partnership in Kartamantul in the future to include not only physical infrastructure but also comprehensive regional development which might involve two other Kabupatens in Yogyakarta Special Region, that is, Kabupatens Kulon Progo and Gunung Kidul. In other words, there is a need to make a plan of

transformation of the secretariat from being a coordinating agency as it functions at present to an implementing agency and a shareholder association in the future.

It should be admitted that the Kartamantul joint secretariat at present might have worked well only in a particular cultural setting of the Special Province of Yogyakarta, under a very respectable Sultan who also traditionally appointed the Governor of the Province. Obviously, the leaderships of all local governments involved play a very important role in this model. The model of joint secretariat metropolitan governance in this region might also be applied to other secondary metropolitan regions in Indonesia and in other developing countries, taking into consideration the specific socio-economic and political conditions of the metropolitan region concerned. Referring to Luo and Shen (2009) study, the model of Kartamantul secretariat is categorized as a spontaneous intercity cooperation.

The BKSP Jabodetabek lacks power and authority and power to perform the task of managing the metropolitan development in the region. Another problem is that the operation of this institution depends greatly on the support of the Provincial Governments of Jakarta, West Java and Banten, each of which participated in this metropolitan institutional collaboration. The BKSP needs to be enhanced to function as a metropolitan governance institution for the Jabodetabek region. A mixed format of local governance is considered as the most appropriate model for the development of the BKSP in Jabodetabek in the future. In this framework, the local, provincial, and local governments have different roles in the management of regional and local development. The central government should have the authority to plan and develop major infrastructure for the whole Jabodetabek area due to the major overhead capital needed, amounts which obviously cannot be covered by provincial or local-government budgets. Moreover, the local and provincial governments need to give up their authority over the above tasks and responsibilities, and meanwhile be permitted to retain the full discretion regarding the administration of local government and the provision of general public services. In short, there is a need to make a transition plan for BKSP from a being powerless coordinating agency, as it is now, to a mixed metropolitan governance institution.

This study also shows that inter-local-government collaboration should not necessarily be orchestrated from above, with great involvement of the central government. In fact, a less hierarchical and bottom-up approach is much more effective in creating inter-local-government partnership for the purposes of urban and regional development. Moreover, cooperation can begin from a sectoral issue or an immediate problem, not necessarily from the comprehensive and long-term development issues. A very important and necessary condition is that there should be openness, trust and transparency among the local governments concerned, as well as collective good leaderships of the local-government heads and the local councils. They should have a shared vision about the importance and necessity of interregional cooperation in order to deal with sectoral problems and the development of the broader region, of which they are part.

Actually, the central government could impose the requirement for such partnership in the revised law of local government, which is now being done. However, such imposition could be counterproductive with the objectives of local and regional development themselves, because it could potentially result in ineffective or 'pseudo' inter-local-government partnerships and cooperation, because interest for such partnership should primarily come from the local governments themselves, not from the central government.

There is a need for the central government to create incentives and disincentives, and compensation and to formulate a clear mechanism for locally initiated local-government partnership. The incentives could be, for instance, a grant provided to those partnerships which have shown good and positive impacts on local and regional development, such as Kartamantul joint secretariat. In the context of Jabodetabek, compensation, for example, should be given to Districts of Bogor and Cianjur, because many parts in those districts are designated as conservation areas of water

recharge in the Jabodetabek Spatial Development Plan (Rencana Tata Ruang Jabodetabek), in which the local governments should not physically develop those areas for residential, industrial or commercial uses, which in turn may result in potential loss of local government's own revenue (Pendapatan Asli Daerah). Actually, a Presidential Decree was enacted in the early 1990 to limit physical development in the conservation areas to prevent future damages, but it has been without a great success in stopping the physical development in the area. Moreover, as Salim and Firman (2010) put forward:

The district government of Bogor has been blamed for excessive giving building permits that convert land cover from open space to building especially in the conservation water catchment area, but they defend themselves by saying that the permit requests came from residents of Jakarta, as well as government offices and private companies in Jakarta that keep buying the lands from the locals. So the cause of environmental degradation in the area that indirectly causes flooding in Jakarta is the people of Jakarta itself. (p. 4)

Overall, this study has tried to identify the link between macro and micro aspects necessary for inter-local-government partnership to work effectively and efficiently. The macro aspects include the need for clear central government policies and political will, incentives and disincentives, and compensations, as exemplified by the BKSP Jabodetabek, whereas the micro aspects involve shared vision of the local-government heads, trusts, transparency and collective leadership, as shown in the case of Kartamantul joint secretariat. Good partnership will work if these two aspects come together.

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